Video 06 | Macros, Drag-to-Assign and Automatic Naming

Massive PSXL instructional series - video script

Runtime estimate	Narration length	Scenes	Format
about 5:18 minutes	749 words at 150 words per minute	12	Screen capture of the plug-in with voice-over; dark theme, interface size 125 percent

Learning goals

- Assign macros and any modulation chip by dragging onto a knob.
- Understand smart macro naming and why it helps hardware and host displays.
- Rename, reset and MIDI-learn macros.

> **NOTE.** Accuracy rule for the narrator and any generated video: use the on-screen names exactly as written in the action column. After **Load Init (Blank)** the synth is silent until routing is connected. Do not compare Massive PSXL to other products.

Scene table

Scene	On-screen action	Narration (word for word)	Visual notes and call-outs
1	Load Init (Blank), quick setup Osc 1 + Osc 2 > Filter 1 > Out; Osc 1 Morph Basic Pos 0.66 Unison 3; Osc 2 Morph Basic Pos 0.66 Pitch -12 Level 0.5; Filter 1 Cutoff 1500.	Macros are sixteen knobs that you attach to whatever you want to play with. First build a simple patch: two saw oscillators into Filter 1 into Out, cutoff around fifteen hundred.	Short sped-up time-lapse of the setup; end on the patch ready.
2	Point at M1 under the first macro knob. Note the label under the knob reads 'Macro 1'.	Look at the macro strip. The first knob is labelled Macro 1, and under it there is a small crosshair chip marked M1. That chip is how you attach the macro. There are sixteen macros in two groups of eight. Group them in your head: the first eight are the ones you will want to show on a controller.	Zoom into the macro strip.
3	Make the Filter 1 tab visible. Drag M1 onto the Cutoff knob. Toast appears. The macro label changes to Filter 1 Cutoff.	Drag the M1 chip onto the Cutoff knob and let go. The message says Macro 1 now controls Filter 1 Cutoff, and look at the label under the macro knob: it has renamed itself. That is smart macro naming. The macro takes the name of the first knob it controls. The name is the full parameter name, such as Filter 1 Cutoff or Reverb Mix, so there is never any doubt what a macro does.	Zoom to the label change. Highlight the toast text.
4	Turn the Macro 1 knob while playing; the Cutoff knob ring and white dot move.	Turn the macro and the filter opens. On the Cutoff knob you can see a coloured ring showing the range, and a white dot following the macro. Macros are normal parameters, so they can also be automated in your DAW. Draw an automation lane for Macro 1 and the filter will follow it.	Split-screen: Macro 1 knob and Cutoff knob side by side.

Scene	On-screen action	Narration (word for word)	Visual notes and call-outs
5	Right-click Cutoff > Edit amount: Macro 1; set +0.5. Then try -0.3.	Right-click the target knob to set the amount. The default is plus point five. A negative amount reverses direction, so turning the macro up would close the filter. Setting up two macros on the same knob, one positive and one negative, is a good way to build crossfade controls.	Show the amount slider and value.
6	Drag M2 onto Reso. Open Osc 1 tab, drag M3 onto Pos. Open Verb tab, drag M4 onto Mix. Show the four macro labels.	Do it again. M2 onto Reso, M3 onto the oscillator Pos, and M4 onto the reverb Mix. Macros are global, so they can control the master effects, which voice modulators cannot. Each macro is now named after its target: Filter 1 Reso, Osc 1 Position, Reverb Mix. Notice the macro for Reverb Mix. Voice modulators cannot control effects, but macros can, which is what makes them ideal for performance controls such as a space knob.	Show a zoom of the four labels in the strip.
7	Dist tab: drag M5 onto Dist Drive, then onto Dist Mix.	A macro can control several knobs. Drag M5 onto Dist Drive and then also onto Dist Mix. It keeps the first name, Dist Drive, and moves both at once. Use different amounts, even negative ones, to make one knob open one thing while closing another. Try assigning the same macro to Osc 1 Pos with plus point four and to Filter 1 Cutoff with minus point two. Turning one knob now changes the timbre and darkens the sound at the same time.	Show M5 turning both knobs.
8	Double-click the M5 chip; Rename dialog; type 'Grit'; OK. Right-click chip > Reset name.	To choose your own name, double-click the chip. Type Grit and press OK. Your name sticks until you choose Reset name from the chip's right-click menu. If you never rename a macro, its name returns to Macro 5 when you remove its last assignment. Names are limited when generated, but when you type your own you can be as descriptive as you like. A short, clear name is best, since hardware displays have little room.	Show the dialog text mentioning hardware displays.
9	Overlay a diagram: plug-in -> host -> controller display. No extra on-screen action.	Why does naming matter? The name is not just a label on screen. It is also the parameter name that the plug-in reports to your host. Controllers and hardware that show parameter names, whether in your DAW's mapping view or on a controller's display, can show Filter 1 Cutoff instead of Macro 1. The macros are also the first parameters in the list, in two groups of eight, so they land on the first pages of a controller. Whether a host or controller refreshes the label immediately depends on that host. If the name does not update, re-selecting the plug-in in the host's mapping list usually fixes it.	Diagram: three boxes with an arrow labelled 'parameter name updates'. Add a text note: 'Display refresh depends on your host.'
10	Right-click a macro knob > MIDI Learn; wiggle a hardware knob (or show the amber ring and the menu text). Right-click again to show Clear MIDI mapping.	To control a macro from hardware, right-click the macro knob and choose MIDI Learn. The knob gets an amber ring. Move a knob on your controller and it is mapped. Mappings are stored in your project. Mod wheel, sustain and the channel messages are reserved and cannot be learned, but every other controller number can.	Show the amber ring and the 'Waiting for MIDI CC...' menu text.
11	Menu > Save preset... > Save, naming it 'Macro Demo'. Reload via Browse. Show macro labels preserved.	Save the sound. The macro names, assignments and amounts all go into the preset. Reload it and everything is as you left it. A macro assignment is part of the sound. If you load a factory synth preset you will often find macros one to four already assigned to Filter 1 Cutoff, Filter 1 Reso, Osc 1 Position and Reverb Mix.	Show the browser with User category selected.

Scene	On-screen action	Narration (word for word)	Visual notes and call-outs
12	End on all four macros turned during a held chord.	Chips are not only for macros. The same drag works for every envelope, LFO, performer and performance source. Next, performers: sequenced sounds from a bar graph.	End card: 'Next: 07 Performers and sequenced sounds'.

Narration only (plain script for text-to-speech or NotebookLM)

[Scene 1] Macros are sixteen knobs that you attach to whatever you want to play with. First build a simple patch: two saw oscillators into Filter 1 into Out, cutoff around fifteen hundred.

[Scene 2] Look at the macro strip. The first knob is labelled Macro 1, and under it there is a small crosshair chip marked M1. That chip is how you attach the macro. There are sixteen macros in two groups of eight. Group them in your head: the first eight are the ones you will want to show on a controller.

[Scene 3] Drag the M1 chip onto the Cutoff knob and let go. The message says Macro 1 now controls Filter 1 Cutoff, and look at the label under the macro knob: it has renamed itself. That is smart macro naming. The macro takes the name of the first knob it controls. The name is the full parameter name, such as Filter 1 Cutoff or Reverb Mix, so there is never any doubt what a macro does.

[Scene 4] Turn the macro and the filter opens. On the Cutoff knob you can see a coloured ring showing the range, and a white dot following the macro. Macros are normal parameters, so they can also be automated in your DAW. Draw an automation lane for Macro 1 and the filter will follow it.

[Scene 5] Right-click the target knob to set the amount. The default is plus point five. A negative amount reverses direction, so turning the macro up would close the filter. Setting up two macros on the same knob, one positive and one negative, is a good way to build crossfade controls.

[Scene 6] Do it again. M2 onto Reso, M3 onto the oscillator Pos, and M4 onto the reverb Mix. Macros are global, so they can control the master effects, which voice modulators cannot. Each macro is now named after its target: Filter 1 Reso, Osc 1 Position, Reverb Mix. Notice the macro for Reverb Mix. Voice modulators cannot control effects, but macros can, which is what makes them ideal for performance controls such as a space knob.

[Scene 7] A macro can control several knobs. Drag M5 onto Dist Drive and then also onto Dist Mix. It keeps the first name, Dist Drive, and moves both at once. Use different amounts, even negative ones, to make one knob open one thing while closing another. Try assigning the same macro to Osc 1 Pos with plus point four and to Filter 1 Cutoff with minus point two. Turning one knob now changes the timbre and darkens the sound at the same time.

[Scene 8] To choose your own name, double-click the chip. Type Grit and press OK. Your name sticks until you choose Reset name from the chip's right-click menu. If you never rename a macro, its name returns to Macro 5 when you remove its last assignment. Names are limited when generated, but when you type your own you can be as descriptive as you like. A short, clear name is best, since hardware displays have little room.

[Scene 9] Why does naming matter? The name is not just a label on screen. It is also the parameter name that the plug-in reports to your host. Controllers and hardware that show parameter names, whether in your DAW's mapping view or on a controller's display, can show Filter 1 Cutoff instead of Macro 1. The macros are also the first parameters in the list, in two groups of eight, so they land on the first pages of a controller. Whether a host or controller refreshes the label immediately depends on that host. If the name does not update, re-selecting the plug-in in the host's mapping list usually fixes it.

[Scene 10] To control a macro from hardware, right-click the macro knob and choose MIDI Learn. The knob gets an amber ring. Move a knob on your controller and it is mapped. Mappings are stored in your project. Mod wheel, sustain and the channel messages are reserved and cannot be learned, but every other controller number can.

[Scene 11] Save the sound. The macro names, assignments and amounts all go into the preset. Reload it and everything is as you left it. A macro assignment is part of the sound. If you load a factory synth preset you will often find macros one to four already assigned to Filter 1 Cutoff, Filter 1 Reso, Osc 1 Position and Reverb Mix.

[Scene 12] Chips are not only for macros. The same drag works for every envelope, LFO, performer and performance source. Next, performers: sequenced sounds from a bar graph.

> **TIP.** Pause for about one second between scenes and let on-screen actions finish before the next sentence starts.